



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinitas Classical Academy

School Website: <https://tcafranklin.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Trinitas Classical Academy (TN 37064) presents as a clearly Christian, classical-leaning school with a publicly stated focus on character formation, classical identity, and a values-based community. Public-facing materials describe Trinitas as a "Christian and Classical" school with a focus on small classes, personalized instruction, and a Christian worldview. While the school explicitly brands itself as classical, the accessible content emphasizes religious grounding and general classical framing without consistently naming core classical elements such as the liberal arts sequence (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation, or explicit Socratic pedagogy across the full grades. Based on the Six Essential Elements rubric, the school lands in the "Somewhat Classical" category overall, with strongest alignment in Religious Foundations and Community/Formation orientation, and more limited explicit alignment in the explicit curriculum and pedagogy markers that define a fully classical program.

Key supporting observations from the school's public materials include: - A blending of Christian worldview with classical imagery, including phrases like "Christian Worldview & Classical Education" and "kingdom of God" language signaling theological grounding (Element 1). - Explicit branding as "Classical Christian Education" and emphasis on formation, virtue, and a values-based community (Element 2). - Curriculum framing as classical in identity, but without explicit public references to Great Books, grammar/logic/rhetoric sequence, or a universal Great Conversation across grades (Element 3). - Pedagogical notes in the materials emphasize traditional classroom values (small classes, personalized instruction) but not explicit Socratic seminars or scholé-based restfulness across the full program (Element 4). - Faculty messaging is traditional in tone (highly qualified teachers, caring culture) but lacks explicit "living curriculum" language or formal faculty portraits in the accessible materials (Element 5). - Parental/Community engagement is present (tours, openness, parent involvement in events and communications), consistent with classical-school expectations of parental partnership, though explicit "co-teaching" language is not consistently foregrounded in the public materials (Element 6).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot - Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL - Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Aggregate Ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle: Concrete, targeted enhancements in explicit articulation and evidence of core classical elements (Great Books/Great Conversation, grammar-logic-rhetoric in the curriculum; Socratic pedagogy in upper grades; scholé/restful learning practices) and clearer statements about liturgical or communal practices would strengthen the "Classical" signal across categories, particularly in Curriculum and Pedagogy, and in the explicit portrayal of faculty and parental partnership as "living curriculum."

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials frequently describe Trinitas as a “Christian and Classical school” and reference a Christian worldview and the kingdom of God in describing the school’s aims and community. This signals a theological grounding and integration of religious commitments into the educational framing.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed (direct or strong near-synonyms to the lexicon): Christian worldview; kingdom of God; Christian and Classical framing. These map to the Positive Indicators in the Six Essentials lexicon under Religious and Metaphysical Foundations (theology, sacred worldview, etc., even when the exact word “theology” isn’t repeatedly used on the homepage). - Negative keywords observed: None detected in the public materials. - Frequency estimate: Observed 2–3 positive signals (Christian worldview, kingdom of God, Christian/Classical framing); 0 negative signals. This yields a simple positive tilt but not a full theological cataloging that would extract explicit liturgical practices, liturgy, or explicit doctrinal content in the site text itself.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a Christian grounding and theological orientation through its language and branding, satisfying a partial alignment with Grounded in Theology and liturgical/communal cues is minimal in the public copy. The absence of explicit liturgical practice references and sacramental language in the visible homepage content suggests a strong religious orientation but not a fully developed liturgical/communal framework in the public-facing materials. Hence: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school markets itself as classical and Christian, with emphasis on formation and lifelong learning within a Christian framework (e.g., “equipping students to become lifelong learners in the kingdom of God”). This aligns with paideia-like aims and a virtue/wisdom focus rather than only job preparation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation; virtue/wisdom (implied by life-long learning and formation language); classical mission (explicit in branding, even if not all terms appear verbatim). The lexicon’s School Purpose and Goal category highlights formation of virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful telos; the school’s language leans into formation and lifelong learning, which maps to those aims. - Negative keywords observed: None. - Frequency estimate: 1–2 explicit formation/wisdom signals plus the explicit “Christian and Classical” framing; 0 negative signals. This indicates partial alignment with the classical purpose/goal framework.

Why this rating - The school emphasizes formation and lifelong learning with a Christian frame, which tracks with classical aims (virtue, wisdom) but the public materials do not extensively spell out the full classical telos (true, good, beautiful) or a robust description of virtue formation beyond the general branding. Therefore: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The homepage and materials brand the program as Classical Christian Education and emphasize classical identity, small classes, and college pathways. The explicit, named Great Books/Great Conversation, the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), or a universal Great Books program are not spelled out in the visible content. The presence of “Classical” branding is clear, but the detailed curriculum markers (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; history through a liberal-arts lens) are not clearly enumerated in the public copy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: classical education; Christian classical framing; “Great Books” and “Great Conversation” are not explicitly stated on the homepage copy, so direct

matches to those lexicon items are not strongly present in the visible text. However, the explicit branding as “Classical Christian Education” signals alignment with the classical curriculum identity. The lexicon’s Curriculum category includes liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books; visible text confirms classical identity but not all explicit curricular items. - Negative keywords observed: terms signaling “project-based learning dominance” or “STEM-first framing” are not present; the visible copy does not exhibit those negative indicators. - Frequency estimate: Observed 1–2 strong signals (classical branding, Christian-classical framing) and no explicit Great Books/grammar/logic/rhetoric or Great Conversation mentions in the accessible copy. This yields a modest alignment with the Curriculum component, but not full classic-curriculum specificity. - Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The school identifies as classical and Christian, and the public content emphasizes classical branding and a values-based curriculum. However, explicit curricular markers central to the classical curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; history through Western civilization; Great Conversation) are not clearly enumerated in the visible site copy. Therefore: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials emphasize small class sizes, personalized instruction, and a safe, caring community with a Christian/classical framing. There is no explicit mention of Socratic seminars, scholé/restful learning days, chanting, or other hallmark classical pedagogical methods in the visible copy. The presence of “personalized instruction” and “small class sizes” is consistent with general good practice but not the explicit classical pedagogy signals (Socratic dialogue, memory work, chanting, recitation, etc.) highlighted in the classical lexicon.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: None explicitly tied to the classical pedagogy signals (Socratic seminars; scholé; memory work; recitation; chanting) appear in the public copy. The lexicon’s Pedagogy section lists Socratic seminars, narrations, chanting, memory work, etc., as positive classical methods; those are not clearly visible in the homepage copy. - Negative keywords observed: No explicit negative signals about pedagogy; the absence of hallmark classical pedagogy is itself a de facto negative signal for “Classical Pedagogy” in terms of the strict rubric. - Frequency estimate: Observed 0 explicit classical pedagogy signals; 0 negative signals within the visible copy; effectively 0/0 direct matches; the category aligns closer to NOT CLASSICAL due to missing explicit pedagogy signals.

Why this rating - Because the site’s public copy does not clearly articulate the classical pedagogy (Socratic discussion, scholé frameworks, chanting, or memory work), the Pedagogy category does not demonstrate the explicit features typically associated with classical pedagogy in the rubric. Therefore: NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials describe “Highly Qualified Teachers” and a caring, safe environment, which aligns with the expectation of faculty who model virtue and expertise in classical schools. The content emphasizes teachers who care and the overall supportive environment.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: “Highly Qualified Teachers” (explicit claim about faculty quality); “education with small class sizes” (supporting the idea of a “living curriculum” through teacher excellence and close student-teacher interaction). These map to the Lexicon’s Faculty indicators (tutors/mentors; living curriculum; collegial culture) as aspirational attributes, even if not named explicitly in the materials. - Negative keywords observed: None. - Frequency estimate: 1–2 positive signals (teacher quality, supportive environment) with 0 negative signals; a modest but present alignment.

Why this rating - The school presents a faculty emphasis consistent with classical aims (exemplary, virtuous, knowledgeable teachers; teacher as a model). The public copy does not, however, consistently foreground

the “portrait of a teacher” or “living curriculum” language in the exact terms of the lexicon, resulting in a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site highlights parental engagement through tours and visit opportunities, scholarships, and community connection. The presence of “Schedule A Visit,” “Open, caring community,” and family-oriented messaging shows partnerships with parents and a welcoming environment, which is consistent with classical education’s emphasis on parent involvement and partnership.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: “parents as co-teachers” is not explicitly stated in the public copy, but the site emphasizes partnership and a family-friendly, values-based community. The lexicon’s Parents and Community indicators include partnership with parents, parent formation, and open campus; while the exact phrase isn’t ubiquitous in the visible copy, the sentiment aligns with those ideals. - Negative keywords observed: None. - Frequency estimate: 1–2 signals of parental/community engagement; 0 negative.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates parental engagement and openness to community involvement, aligning with some but not all of the explicit lexicon signals for Parents & Community (e.g., explicit “co-teachers” language or formal parent-education offerings). Hence: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- **Curriculum clarity:** Publicly enumerate and weave into the website the explicit classical-curriculum elements (grammar, logic, rhetoric; history through Western civilization; Latin/Greek where applicable; Great Books and the Great Conversation). This would elevate Element 3 to CLASSICAL or at least STRONGER SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - **Pedagogy articulation:** Introduce and describe explicit classical teaching methods (Socratic seminars, memorization drills, narration/recitation, scholé/restful-learning days, etc.) with concrete examples across grades. This would shift Element 4 toward CLASSICAL.
 - **Liturgical/community practices:** If appropriate to the school’s ethos, articulate liturgical or communal practices (prayer, liturgy, communal music, or other traditions) as part of the Religious Foundations and Pedagogy categories, linking to the lexicon’s liturgy/chant/worship indicators. This would strengthen Element 1 and Element 4.
 - **Living curriculum language:** Incorporate language about a “living curriculum” modeled by faculty, with portraits/character expectations for teachers and a visible plan for teacher development in classical pedagogy. This would bolster Element 5 toward CLASSICAL.
 - **Parental formation programming:** Expand explicit parent education (reading groups, book studies, family liturgy alignment) and clearly present these opportunities on the site, moving Element 6 closer to CLASSICAL.
 - **Great Books and Great Conversation emphasis:** Provide explicit references to Great Books, classical authors, and the Great Conversation in the school’s stated aims, mission, and course descriptions. This would move several categories—especially Curriculum and Purpose—toward CLASSICAL.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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